BY ORDER OF THE
SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
INSTRUCTION 36-2678

26 AUGUST 2025
Corrective Action, 21 NOVEMBER 2025

Personnel

EDUCATION CLASSIFICATION AND CODING

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing website at www.e-Publishing.af.mil for downloading or ordering.

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication.

OPR: AF/A1D | Certified by: SAF/MR

Supersedes: DAFI36-2678, 10 November 2022 | Pages: 30

This publication implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management.* It provides guidance and criteria to classify and code educational levels, education specialties, education subspecialties, and the method used to obtain education levels for the Military Personnel Data System (MilPDS). This publication applies to Department of the Air Force (DAF) uniformed members of the United States Air Force (USAF), United States Space Force (USSF), the Air Force Reserve (AFR), and the Air National Guard (ANG), except where otherwise noted. In collaboration with the Chief of Air Force Reserve (AF/RE), the Director of the Air National Guard (NGB/CF), and the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel (SF/S1), the Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services (AF/A1) develops personnel policy for Total Force Development. All references to USAF terminology, units, and positions will also apply to the equivalent USSF terminology, units, and positions, as appropriate. For example, references to major commands or numbered Air Forces will also apply to Space Force field commands. References to Air Force wings will also apply to Space Force Deltas. Air Staff roles and responsibilities (e.g., AF/A1) may also apply to the equivalent Chief of Space Operations office (e.g., SF/S1), as appropriate. This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all supplements must be routed to the office of primary responsibility (OPR) listed above for coordination prior to certification and approval. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the OPR listed above using DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*; route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate chain of command. The authorities to waive wing, unit, or delta level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, T-3") number following the compliance statement. See Department of the Air Force Manual (DAFMAN) 90-161, *Publishing*

Processes and Procedures, Table A10.1 for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to the publication OPR for non-tiered compliance items. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed of in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. The use of the name or mark of any specific manufacturer, commercial product, commodity, or service in this publication does not imply endorsement by the DAF.

Chapter 1—OVERVIEW **4**

1.1. Overview. 4

Chapter 2—ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES **5**

2.1. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs (SAF/MR). 5

2.2. Deputy Chief of Staff, Manpower, Personnel and Services (AF/A1). 5

2.3. Directorate of Force Development (AF/A1D). 5

2.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel (SF/S1). 5

2.5. Director, Force Development (SF/S1D). 5

2.6. Air University (AU). 5

2.7. United States Air Force Academy (USAFA). 6

2.8. Education and Training Section (E&TS). 6

Chapter 3—GUIDANCE AND PROCEDURES FOR UPDATING ACADEMIC RECORDS **7**

3.1. Air University (AU). 7

3.2. The AU Office of the Registrar. 7

3.3. Education and Training Section (E&TS). 7

3.4. Accessions. 8

Table 3.1. Education Updates for Accessions. 9

Chapter 4—EDUCATION LEVEL UPDATES **15**

4.1. Accreditation. 15

4.2. Acceptable Documentation. 15

Chapter 5—EDUCATION LEVEL UPDATE PROCESS **18**

5.1. Officer Updates. 18

5.2. Enlisted Updates. 19

Chapter 6—EDUCATION CLASSIFICATION AND CODES 20

6.1. Coding of Academic Specialty. 20

Table 6.1. Academic Specialty Codes. 20

6.2. Coding of Education Level. 21

Table 6.2. MilPDS Education Level Degree Codes. 22

Table 6.3. Method/Resource Used to Obtain Education Level Codes. 24

Chapter 7—MISCELLANEOUS EDUCATION RECORD UPDATES 25

7.1. Miscellaneous Education Record Updates. 25

Table 7.1. Miscellaneous Education Record Updates. 25

Attachment 1—GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION 26

Chapter 1

OVERVIEW

1.1. Overview. Education Classification and Coding provides a standardized method and instruction for collecting and maintaining education level and education specialty information for Department of the Air Force (DAF) Service members. The DAF uses academic information for various purposes throughout a Service member's military career. Accuracy and standardization of data is imperative to ensure correctness of DAF Service members records.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs (SAF/MR).

2.1.1. Serves as an agent of the Secretary of the Air Force and provides guidance, direction, and oversight for all matters pertaining to the formulation, review, and execution of plans, policies, programs, and budgets addressing military education.

2.2. Deputy Chief of Staff, Manpower, Personnel and Services (AF/A1).

2.2.1. Provides operational oversight and advocacy for DAF Voluntary Education Program.

2.2.2. Establishes, maintains, coordinates, and operates the Voluntary Education Program encompassing a broad range of educational experiences to include, but not limited to, academic skills development, high school completion programs, vocational programs, technical programs, and programs leading to the completion of undergraduate and graduate degrees.

2.3. Directorate of Force Development (AF/A1D).

2.3.1. Provides guidance and oversees policies for Service member education classification and coding.

2.3.2. Coordinates with stakeholders on information systems to establish data linkages to facilitate degree updates for DAF Service members.

2.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel (SF/S1).

2.4.1. Provides support to operational oversight and advocacy for the DAF Voluntary Education Program as it pertains to Guardians.

2.5. Director, Force Development (SF/S1D).

2.5.1. Supports AF/A1D policies and procedures for education classification and coding as it pertains to Guardians.

2.5.2. Coordinates with USSF stakeholders on information systems to establish data linkages to facilitate degree updates for Guardians, as required.

2.6. Air University (AU).

2.6.1. Develops, manages, and updates degree-applicable specialty codes for undergraduate and graduate degrees and programs within Military Personnel Data System (MilPDS).

2.6.1.1. Requests updates for the lookup table, to include education method, school name, and transcript verification status.

2.6.1.2. Ensures optimal alignment of academic specialty codes (ASC) with the United States categorize academic programs at higher academic institutions Classification of Instructional Programs (CIP) codes.

2.6.2. Provides academic support for updating Officer (including Warrant Officers CW2 and above) academic records for Air Force, Space Force, Guard, and Reserve officers through the AU Office of the Registrar for undergraduate and graduate degrees (**Exception**: USAFA and all other non-Community College of the Air Force (CCAF) related enlisted degree).

2.7. United States Air Force Academy (USAFA).

2.7.1. Updates academic records for USAFA graduates. The USAFA Manpower, Personnel, Services, and Officer Accessions Directorate (USAFA/A1) updates education records of each graduating cadet.

2.8. Education and Training Section (E&TS).

2.8.1. Provides support for updating enlisted academic records for Air Force and Space Force enlisted Service members and WO1 Warrant Officers for undergraduate and graduate degrees.

Chapter 3

GUIDANCE AND PROCEDURES FOR UPDATING ACADEMIC RECORDS

3.1. Air University (AU). AU will provide guidance on identifying AU degree-applicable specialty codes, through the AU Office of the Registrar. **(T-1)**

3.2. The AU Office of the Registrar. Will review, classify, and code officer transcripts for update and maintain education levels for entry. The Air Force Automated Education Management System (AFAEMS) will be used to update Officer records to flow into the MilPDS. **(T-1)** Accession agencies will not update officer education records in the MilPDS. **(T-1)**

3.2.1. Officer Education Level Update. The AU Office of the Registrar will update officer education levels for initial accessions and initial education levels in MilPDS. Source document(s) will be uploaded into the Service members AFAEMS record, for audit purposes. **(T-1)** In the event the accessions source fails to provide the AU Office of the Registrar with an official transcript to update, as instructed in **Table 3.1**, it becomes the Service member's responsibility to provide the AU Office of the Registrar the official transcript. **(T-1)**

3.2.2. Official Transcripts. The AU Office of the Registrar will use official transcripts and/or official documentation from awarding academic institutions as documentation for all education level updates. **(T-1)** The AU Office of the Registrar will only accept transcripts reflecting degree award/conferral dates. **(T-1)**

3.2.3. Return of Official Transcript. Official transcripts will not be returned to Service members for personal use or release outside of the Department of Defense (DoD). **(T-1)** Once the AU Office of the Registrar receives a transcript, it becomes property of the DAF and will only be used for official DoD purposes. **(T-1)** Once official transcripts are digitally filed in a Service member's AFAEMS record, the hardcopy versions may be disposed of in accordance with approved records management procedures.

3.2.4. Internal Request for Transcripts. Internal requests for access to transcripts received by the AU Office of the Registrar may be granted at the discretion of the AU Office of the Registrar.

3.2.5. Document Maintenance. The AU Office of the Registrar will maintain all official documentation (e.g., transcripts) in the Service members AFAEMS record, for audit purposes. **(T-1)**

3.3. Education and Training Section (E&TS). Will review, classify, and code enlisted transcripts for update and maintain education levels for entry. AFAEMS will be used to update enlisted records to flow into the MilPDS. **(T-1)**

3.3.1. Enlisted Education Level Updates. The E&TS evaluates education achievements and updates records for enlisted Service members (as described in **Section 3.3**). Education levels are updated in MilPDS via AFAEMS. **(T-1)** Enlisted Service members are responsible for using personal funds to obtain an official transcript from their degree-awarding academic institution to have education levels updated. **(T-1)**

3.3.2. Official Transcripts. Only official transcripts, hard-copy and/or electronic, from awarding academic institutions will be accepted to update enlisted Service members education

levels. **(T-1)** Official transcripts will be verified prior to updating a Service member's record (as described in **Section 4.2**). **(T-1)**

3.3.3. Official Transcript Not Available. If an official transcript is not available, approved supplementary documentation will be accepted (as described in **Section 4.2**). **(T-1)** Supplementary documents (e.g., for promotion boards) will be received using secure methods directly from the academic institution to the E&TS (as described in **Section 4.2**). **(T-1)**

3.3.4. Document Maintenance. Documentation will be maintained electronically in the Service member's AFAEMS record. **(T-1)**

3.3.5. Return of Official Transcript. Official transcripts will not be returned to Service members for personal use or release outside of the Department of Defense (DoD). **(T-1)** Once the E&TS receives a transcript, it becomes property of the DAF and will only be used for official DoD purposes. **(T-1)** Once official transcripts are digitally filed in a service member's AFAEMS record, the hardcopy versions may be disposed of in accordance with approved records management procedures.

3.3.6. Officers Degree Updates. The E&TS will not update officer education records in the MilPDS. **(T-1)**

3.4. Accessions. Organizations listed in **Table 3.1** must obtain official documentation to validate and update DAF Service members' records. **(T-1)**

3.4.1. Before Accession.

3.4.1.1. Official Transcripts. DAF Recruiting Service will accept official transcripts for all recruits, other than those noted in **Table 3.1**, and will file transcript(s) in Service member's original accession package and forward the package to the Service member's gaining Force Support Squadron Military Personnel Flight. **(T-1)** Recruits are responsible for using personal funds to obtain an official transcript from their degree-awarding academic institution. **(T-1)**

3.4.1.2. Document Maintenance for Officers. DAF Recruiting Service will obtain official transcripts for officer recruits and attach transcript to the recruits' DD Form 1966, *Record of Military Processing – Armed Forces of the United States*, when sending Officer packages to the 737th Training Squadron for processing. **(T-1)**

3.4.1.3. Document Maintenance for Enlisted. DAF Recruiting Service will obtain official transcript(s) for enlisted recruits and attach transcript(s) to the recruits' DD Form 1966 *Record of Military Processing – Armed Forces of the United States*, with transcript(s) attached, substantiates education data for those accessed into the DAF. **(T-1)** The 737th Training Squadron personnel will process forms into the Automated Records Management System (ARMS). **(T-1)** Accession agencies will not update enlisted education records in the MilPDS. **(T-1)**

3.4.1.4. Document Maintenance for Reserve Component. DAF Reserve Component Service member's official transcript(s) will be sent to the servicing Reserve Service member's personnel flight/education and training function. **(T-1)**

3.4.2. After Accession.

3.4.2.1. Officer Degree Completion. Officers are responsible for using personal funds to obtain an official transcript from their degree-awarding academic institution. **(T-1)** The academic institution must send the transcript either by mail or electronically to the AU Office of the Registrar within 90 calendar days of graduation. **(T-1) Note:** Degrees earned below the bachelor's level are not recorded or updated for DAF officers.

3.4.2.2. Prior Enlisted Commissioned Officers. Enlisted Service members who have been commissioned through a recognized DAF commissioning program must personally fund official transcript from the degree awarding academic institution. **(T-1)** The academic institution must send the transcript either by mail or electronically to the AU Office of the Registrar within 90 calendar days of graduation. **(T-1)**

3.4.2.3. Enlisted Degree Completions. Enlisted Service members are responsible for using personal funds to obtain an official transcript from their degree-awarding academic institution. **(T-1)** The academic institution must send the transcript either by mail, electronically, or through the AI Portal. **(T-1)** The AI Portal is the preferred method for enlisted Service members. **Note:** Undergraduate and graduate degrees, to include associate degrees, are recorded and updated for DAF enlisted Service members.

Table 3.1. Education Updates for Accessions.

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
1	an officer accessed for the first time into Department of the Air Force (DAF)	attached to DD Form 1966 by the DAF recruiter	The Air University (AU) Office of the Registrar for education level update **Note:** Within Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC), also send to the respective Reserve Education and Training Office) (**Note 1**)	90 calendar days of accession. **(T-1)**
2	an Officer Training School graduate (except Airman Education and Commissioning Program and nurses)	obtained by the officer trainee	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	90 calendar days of commissioning. **(T-1)**

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
3	United States Air Force Academy (USAFA) graduate	Maintained by and obtained from United States Air Force Academy, Dean of Faculty, Examination and Records (USAFA/DFVR)	Graduate data will be sent to MilPDS via AFAEMS by electronic file from USAFA Manpower, Personnel, Services, and Officer Accessions Directorate (USAFA/A1)	
4	an Air Force Reserve Officer Training Corps (AFROTC) graduate	obtained by the Professor of Aerospace Studies at AFROTC detachment	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	
5	an AFROTC distinguished graduate	submitted with the Distinguished Graduate Certificate with the AF Form 24, *Application for Appointment as Reserve of the Air Force or USAF Without Component*	Air Force Personnel Center (AFPC) Officer Accessions (AFPC/DP1TSA) and Service member's master personnel record in Automated Records Management System (ARMS) for updates. **(T-1)**	Within 5 business days of commissioning. **(T-1)**
6	a Medical Services Officer (for Air Force Specialty Codes (AFSC) 4XXX) through Direct Commission Medical Services Officer Program	obtained by AFPC Medical Career Management Division (AFPC/DP2N) for certification and verification	AFPC/DP1TSA and Service member's master personnel record in ARMS for updates **(T-1)**	as soon as available, but no later than 90 calendar days of commissioning. **(T-1)**
7	an officer accessed through the Direct Commission Chaplain Program	obtained by the AFPC Chaplain Career Management Branch (AFPC/DP2NH)	The AU Office of the Registrar	90 calendar days of accession. **(T-1)**

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
8	an officer accessed through the Judge Advocate Direct Appointment Program	obtained by the Headquarters Air Force Office of the Judge Advocate General, Professional Development Directorate (HQ USAF/JAX)	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	
9	military doctor or dentist with a professional (Medicine (MD), Osteopathy (DO), Dentistry (DMD or DDS) degree	obtained by the Air Force Centralized Credentials Verification Office, (AFCCVO) for primary source verification	AFPC/DP2N for certification and verification and in turn sent to The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	
10	a physician contractually obligated through Health Professions Scholarship Program, Financial Assistance Program and AFROTC completing training in deferred status	obtained by the Physician Career Management Branch (AFPC/DP2NP)	AFPC/DP2N for certification and verification in turn sent to The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	90 calendar days of the certification process. **(T-1)**
11	a foreign medical officer	obtained by the AFPC/DP2NP and ensures the Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduate certificate is attached to an International Medical Graduate transcript	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	90 calendar days of accession. **(T-1)**

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
12	approved by Air Reserve Personnel Center (ARPC) for commission in the Air Reserve Component (ARC)	obtained by Air Force Reserve Command Directorate of Recruiting Service (AFRC/RS), Air Force Reserve Command Directorate of Health Services (AFRC/SG), Air Force Reserve Command Chaplain Corps (AFRC/HC), and Air Force Reserve Command Staff Judge Advocate (AFRC/JA)		
13	accessed via Direct Commissioning Program or an inter-service transfer into Reserve programs as medical services officers, chaplains, or judge advocates **(T-1)**	obtained from the Air Force Recruiting Service and for judge advocates, HQ USAF/JAX	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**) Air Reserve Personnel Center Accessions Branch (ARPC/DPAR)	
14	approved by Officer Programs and Policy Branch (NGB/A1PO) for commission in the Air National Guard (ANG)	obtained by State Joint Forces Headquarters	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**)	90 calendar days. **(T-1)**

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
15	an officer and has earned a degree, credits, or a certificate through a program other than those covered in rules above and after commissioning and accession	requested and paid for by the officer from the academic institution awarding degree or credits **Note:** Service members completing an AFIT program, AFIT to provided materials to the AU Office of the Registrar confirming graduate degree upon successful completion of AFIT program		
16	enlisted and has earned a degree, credits or certificate after accession (**Note 2**)	requested and paid for by the enlisted Service member from institution awarding degree or credits	to the Service members assigned E&TS	
17	an Airman accessed for commission in the Air National Guard	obtained by Joint Forces Headquarters	The AU Office of the Registrar (**Note 1**) **Note:** The AU Office of the Registrar does not have access to the recruits' records and cannot perform any updates until the Service member is commissioned	90 calendar days of commission. **(T-1)**

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then an official transcript is	C and sent to the following for updates	D within
18	earns a Foreign Medical Graduate certificate	the AFPC/DP2NP ensures the Educational Commission for Foreign Medical Graduate certificate is attached to an International Medical Graduate transcript	The AU Office of the Registrar for update for Foreign Medical Officers **(T-1)**	90 calendar days of certificate completion. **(T-1)**
Notes: 1. Does not apply for Air Reserve Component officers not on extended active duty. 2. Not required for Community College of the Air Force (CCAF) degrees or other Tuition Assistance (TA) funded degrees via the Air Force Voluntary Education Center (AFVEC).				

Chapter 4

EDUCATION LEVEL UPDATES

4.1. Accreditation. The DAF will recognize academic institutions with nationally or regionally recognized institutional accreditation and candidacy for education level updates. **(T-1)** Academic institutions require additional recognition will follow this instruction for guidance. **(T-1)** The Council for Higher Education Accreditation published website provides accreditation information.

4.1.1. Accredited Institutions and Programs. The DAF follows the United States Governments, applicable governing agency, provided directory for accredited institutions and programs. DAF offices completing education level updates must verify accredited institutions and candidates for accreditation. **(T-1)** Further questions concerning the accreditation status of academic institution will be addressed by the AU Office of the Registrar.

4.1.2. Non-Recognized Academic Institutions. Universities, colleges, or training schools who do not meet the criteria mentioned in **Section 4.1** and want to be recognized will submit a request to the appropriate accrediting agency/association for inclusion applicable governing agency guides. It is the academic institution's responsibility to provide the AU Office of the Registrar with documentation to prove accreditation, candidacy, or federal degree granting authority. Information provided will be forwarded to the Digital Transformation Activity Human Capital Management Requirements Branch (DTA/DPRH) for input into MilPDS. **(T-1)**

4.1.3. Non-accredited Institutions. Education level updates for non-accredited institutions will only be accepted if the Service member self-funds and obtains a statement from an accredited academic institution confirming acceptance of the education credits from the non-accredited institution. **(T-1)**

4.2. Acceptable Documentation.

4.2.1. Official Documentation. Official source documentation includes hard-copy and electronic transcripts, as well as formal documents and Letters of Intentions on academic institution letterhead from accredited institutions, with an award/confer date.

4.2.1.1. Hard-copy Transcripts. Hard-copy transcripts must be provided in a sealed, stamped, official envelope with the seal intact and will be saved in the Service member's AFAEMS record. **(T-1)** Enlisted Service members will send hard-copy transcripts to the E&TS for records updates. **(T-1)** Officer hard-copy transcripts will be sent to the AU Office of the Registrar for record updates. **(T-1)**

4.2.1.2. Electronic Transcripts. Electronic transcripts must be sent via secure methods directly from the academic institution. (T-1) Enlisted Service members will send electronic transcripts to the E&TS or through the AI Portal for records updates. **(T-1)** Officer electronic transcripts will be sent to the AU Office of the Registrar for record updates. **(T-1)**

4.2.1.2.1. AI Portal. Academic institution updates from the AI Portal are recognized as official source documents, even in the absence of separate source documents. The E&TS will update enlisted Service members' education records based on award or conferment details provided by the academic institution. **(T-1)**

4.2.1.2.2. Fiori. Transcripts retrieved from CCAF's Fiori system are recognized as official source documents. The E&TS will update enlisted Service members' education records based on award or conferment details provided by the academic institution. **(T-1)**

4.2.1.3. Formal Documents. The Service member must request the institution provide an official letter on the institution's letterhead, signed by the registrar's office including the student's name, degree (or major area of study), program level (e.g., certificate), date of completion of degree requirements, and the date the degree will be awarded/conferred. **(T-1)**

4.2.2. Letter of Intention to Graduate. Service members who have completed all degree requirements, but whose academic institution has yet to award/confer the degree, may request a 90-day temporary update from the Service member. If the degree has already been awarded, an official transcript must be sent for record update. **(T-1)**

4.2.2.1. Letter of Intention to Graduate Requirements. Letters if intentions must be provided on official academic institution letterhead, signed by the registrar's office, and include the student's name, degree (or major area of study), program level (e.g., certificate), date of completion of degree requirements, and the date the degree will be awarded/conferred. **(T-1)** The conferral date must be used to update a Service member's permanent academic record. **(T-1) Note:** Letters containing pending actions by the institution to include financial, academic, or other audits will not be accepted for record updates. **(T-1)**

4.2.2.2. Award/Confer Transcript. It is the Service member's responsibility to ensure an official transcript with award/confer date is provided to the AU Office of the Registrar (officers) or the Service member's assigned E&TS (enlisted) once available but no later than 90 days after granting of conferred degree. **(T-1)** Failure to update the letter of intention with an official transcript will result in the removal of the degree from the Service member's record. **(T-1)**

4.2.2.3. Degree Not Awarded/Conferred for Promotion Board. If a degree is not awarded/conferred for a Promotion Board, the E&TS will correct Service members record in AFAEMS and notify AFPC Promotions Operations Security (AFPC/DP2SPP). **(T-1)** This notification will initiate the process to remove the degree and correct any erroneous board information, ensuring accuracy in promotion and selection board records. **(T-1)** The enlisted Service member has 90 days following record update using a Letter of Intention to Graduate, to provide the E&TS an official transcript with awarded/conferred date. **(T-1)**

4.2.3. High School Completion. High School diplomas will be accepted from accredited institutions and high school equivalency certificates. **(T-1)**

4.2.3.1. The General Educational Development (GED) test certificates and academic education level B will be accepted when the Service member achieves a standard score of 35 on each test and an average standard score of 45 on all five parts. **(T-1)**

4.2.4. DAF Reserve Component. Prior Service members enlisting in a DAF Reserve Component may use their DD Form 214, *Certificate of Uniformed Service* as acceptable source document for verifying high school completion.

4.2.5. Associate Degree. It is the Service member's responsibility to ensure a self-funded official transcript from accredited academic institutions with an award/confer date is provided for degree update. **(T-1)** Official transcripts will be verified prior to updating a Service member's record. **(T-1) Note:** Degrees below the bachelor level are not updated for DAF officers unless specifically required (e.g., Air National Guard Nurse Corps personnel). **(T-1)**

4.2.6. AU Associate Degree. AU Associate of Applied Science (AAS) degree, awarded through the CCAF, is updated by AU. **(T-1)** Service members do not need to provide transcripts for AU-awarded degrees, as education levels and degree confers are updated via the AU Student Transcript Admission Record System data transfer to flow automatically into MilPDS.

4.2.7. Credits Exceeding an Associate but Under a Bachelor Degree. Education credits from accredited academic institutions must be verified with an official transcript or other official documentation from the academic institution, prior to records update. **(T-1)**

4.2.8. Bachelor, Graduate, and Doctorate Degree. An official transcript from the academic institution is required to update the Service member's record. Officers will work with the AU Office of the Registrar and enlisted Service members will work with their assigned E&TS. **(T-1)**

4.2.9. Certificate and Credentials. The E&TS will only update professional certificates allocated an academic code that is included on an official academic institution transcript. **(T-1)** Credentials earned using Air Force Credentialing Opportunities On-Line (AFCOOL) funds will not be updated by the E&TS. **(T-1) Note:** Technical and occupational certificates are not updated for DAF officers.

4.2.10. International Institutions. A degree completed with an international institution will only be updated in the Service members official record once an official evaluation and foreign transcripts have been received. **(T-1)**

4.2.10.1. Translated Evaluation. Education level updates will only be accepted for a course completed with an international institution if the Service member self-funds and obtains a translated evaluation of completed course(s) from the foreign institutions. **(T-1)**

4.2.10.2. Evaluation Accreditation. An accredited academic institution or private evaluation agency must be used. **(T-1)** The evaluation agency must be a member of the National Association of Credential Evaluation Services. **(T-1)** Evaluations must state the degree summary, the United States equivalency on the first page, and contain a class-by-class evaluation. **(T-1) Note:** AU is not an approve evaluator.

Chapter 5

EDUCATION LEVEL UPDATE PROCESS

5.1. Officer Updates. DAF officers are responsible for maintaining the accuracy of their individual education records. **(T-1)** It is the officer's responsibility to coordinate with the degree-issuing academic institution and personally fund transcript and document fees, the DAF will not provide reimbursement for costs accrued. **(T-1)** Transcripts and documents must be sent directly from the issuing academic institution to the AU Office of the Registrar, either by mail or electronically. **(T-1) Note:** Transcripts issued directly to the officer will only be accepted if the transcript and/or document is in its original sealed, unopened envelope from the issuing academic institution. **(T-1)**

5.1.1. Mandatory Field Updates. To ensure accurate record-keeping and proper classification of an officer's educational background, the following education level fields are required when updating an officer's academic degree information in MilPDS: Academic Specialty Code (**Table 6.1**.), MilPDS Education Level Degree Codes (**Table 6.2**.), Method/Resource Used to Obtain Education Level Codes (**Table 6.3**), and academic method to identify the funding type. **(T-1)**

5.1.2. AU Office of the Registrar Requirement. The AU Office of the Registrar will complete the education level update in AFAEMS and load official source document(s) into the Service members AFAEMS record, for audit purposes. **(T-1)** Source documents must include the conferral date. **(T-1)** Verified, by AU Office of the Registrar, hard-copy transcripts will be signed and dated, including a statement verifying its official nature, and maintained digitally in the Service member's AFAEMS record. **(T-1)**

5.1.3. AU Award Degrees. AU awarded degrees do not require transcript submission for update. Conferrals are automatically updated in MilPDS via the AU Student Transcript Admission Record System.

5.1.4. Line Officers. For Line officers attending Air Force Institute of Technology (AFIT) sponsored programs (including AFIT civilian institution programs) AFIT will provide materials to AU Office of the Registrar before the AU Office of the Registrar will update the education level and degree program ASC upon receipt of official transcripts. **(T-1) Note:** If a degree program indicated on a transcript differs from the AU Office of the Registrar ASC source document, the AU Office of the Registrar will consult with the Air Force Learning Division, Education Branch (AF/A1DLE) for clarification before updating the record. **(T-1)** The ASCs list is located at **Table 6.1**.

5.1.5. In-resident Medical Personnel. For medical personnel attending in-residence AFIT graduate programs, the AU Office of the Registrar will update Service member's record upon receipt of the official transcript and the AFIT Graduate Health Care Division (AFIT/CIM) source document, reflecting the ASC the Service member was sponsored to receive. **(T-1)** Service members requesting an ASC change must first obtain approval from AFIT/CIM through HQ USAF. **(T-1)**

5.1.6. AFIT-sponsored Medical Personnel. For medical personnel attending AFIT-sponsored medical program, the AU Office of the Registrar will update Service member's record upon receipt of official source documentation from AFIT/CIM. **(T-1)** The appropriate AFPC/DP2N office (by AFSC) approves exceptions to this policy. **(T-1)**

5.2. Enlisted Updates. Enlisted Service members are responsible for ensuring the accuracy of their individual education record. **(T-1)** It is the enlisted Service member's responsibility to coordinate with the degree-issuing academic institution and personally fund transcript and document fees, the DAF will not provide reimbursement for costs accrued. **(T-1)** Transcripts and documents must be sent directly from the issuing academic institution either by mail or electronically directly to the E&TS or through the AI Portal. **(T-1) Note:** Transcripts issued directly to the enlisted Service member will only be accepted if the transcript and/or document is in its original sealed, unopened envelope from the issuing academic institution. **(T-1)**

5.2.1. Mandatory Field Updates. To ensure accurate record-keeping and proper classification of an enlisted Service member's educational background, the following education level fields are required when updating academic degree information in MilPDS: Academic Specialty Code (**Table 6.1**.), MilPDS Education Level Degree Codes (**Table 6.2**.), Method/Resource Used to Obtain Education Level Codes (**Table 6.3**), and academic method to identify the funding type. **(T-1)**

5.2.2. E&TS Requirement. The E&TS will complete the education level update in AFAEMS and load official source document(s) into the Service members AFAEMS record, for audit purposes. **(T-1)** Source documents must include the conferral date. **(T-1)** Verified, by E&TS, hard-copy transcripts will be signed and dated, including a statement verifying its official nature, and maintained digitally in the Service member's AFAEMS record. **(T-1)**

5.2.3. Promotions, Selection Boards, and Assignment Eligibility. Senior noncommissioned officers meeting a promotion or selection board or are eligible for assignment and require an official transcript not immediately available from the degree-granting academic institution, the E&TS will accept a letter of intention (as described in **Subsection 4.2.2**) from the academic institution. **(T-1)** The letter will be used to update the Service member's AFAEMS record until the official transcript is obtained. **(T-1)** The E&TS will record degree completion date as education level completion date. **(T-1)**

5.2.3.1. Final Cutoff Date for Boards. Promotion and selection boards establish final cutoff dates for Service member record updates. Updates made after the board-identified cutoff date may not be included in the consideration process, as last-minute changes cannot be guaranteed for inclusion. **(T-1)**

5.2.3.2. Receipt of Official Transcript. Upon receipt of official transcript, the E&TS will update the education level in the Service members AFAEMS record. **(T-1)** It is the responsibility of the Service member to provide the updated data to AFPC/DP2SPP. **(T-1)** Updates processed with a Letter of Intention from the academic institution are only valid for 90-days. **(T-1)** Lack of official transcript, provided the Service member will result the Service members awarded/conferred record being retroactively deleted in the system. **(T-1)**

Chapter 6

EDUCATION CLASSIFICATION AND CODES

6.1. Coding of Academic Specialty. The Academic Specialty Code (ASC) categorizes fields of study, encompassing general areas, major disciplines, specializations, and sub-specializations. **Table 6.1** highlights the most commonly used ASCs within the DAF, while a comprehensive list can be found in the AFAEMS Resource Section. Determining the appropriate ASC may require reviewing the academic institution's catalog and collaborating with both the institution and the Service member.

Table 6.1. Academic Specialty Codes.

General Areas of Study and Major Academic Fields	
0 INTER-AREA SPECIALIZATIONS	5 LAW
0C Computer Science	5A Civil Law
0G General/Liberal Studies	5B Military Justice
0I Information Systems Management	5E Environmental Law
0S Aerospace Studies	6 MATHEMATICS
0Y Inter Area Specializations	6A Algebra
1 ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEMENT	6B Analysis and Function Analysis
1& Military Science	6C Geometry
1A Business Administration and Management	6D Logic and Foundations
1E Emergency Management	6E Mathematics of Resource Use
1F Fitness, Recreation and Services Management	6F Number Theory
2 ARTS, HUMANITIES AND EDUCATION	6G Numerical Methods and Computation
2A Chaplaincy and Pastoral Care	6H Probability
2B Education	6I Statistics
2C Fine and Applied Arts	6J Topology
2D Foreign Language	7 MEDICAL SCIENCES
2E Humanities	7A Allied Sciences/Prof Services
2F Language and Communicative Arts	7B Dental Science
2G Philosophy	7C Hospital Administration
2H Religion	7D Medicine & Surgery
2I Arts, Humanities and Education Technology	7E Nursing
2K Small Arms Training and Maintenance	7F Veterinary Medicine
3 BIOLOGICAL & AGRICULTURAL	7G Health Care Sciences Occupational Technology
3A Biology	7H Chiropractic Medicine
3B Agriculture	8 PHYSICAL SCIENCES
4 ENGINEERING	8A Astronomy
4A Aeronautical Engineering	8B Cartographic Sciences
4B Aerospace Engineering	8C Chemistry

4C Agricultural Engineering	8D Earth Sciences
4D Architectural Engineering	8E Hydrospheric Sciences
4E Astronautical Engineering	8F Meteorology
4F Materials Science & Engineering	8G Imaging Sciences
4G Chemical Engineering	8H Physics
4H Civil Engineering	9 SOCIAL SCIENCES
4I Electrical Engineering	9A Anthropology
4J General Engineering	9B Economics
4K Engineering Sciences	9C Geography
4L Industrial Engineering	9D History
4M Mechanical Engineering	9E Political Science
Note: A complete list of breakout codes for academic fields is in the Air Force Automated Education Management System (AFAEMS) Resource Section.	

6.2. Coding of Education Level. Education levels have either a single alpha or numeric character code in the MilPDS. The standard measures for determining education levels within the MilPDS are semester hours and degrees. Quarter hours will be converted to semester hours. **(T-1)** One quarter hour equals two-thirds of one semester hour. **Table 6.2** lists the various MilPDS education level degree codes.

6.2.1. System Limitations for Education Levels. A maximum of five education levels may be assigned and coded for DAF Service members in MilPDS.

6.2.2. Two Degrees Same Level. Service members who earn two degrees at the same education level will have the most recently earned degree coded to list first. **(T-1)**

6.2.3. Dual Majors. Service members who earn a dual major degree will only have one degree level reflected in coding. **(T-1)** Service members will have to choose which major to reflect in the system. **(T-3)** To receive credit for both majors, as individual degrees, the academic institution would need to assign individual graduation dates for each major.

Table 6.2. MilPDS Education Level Degree Codes.

Note: Updates should occur no later than 15 days upon Service member entering a program.	
Data Items and Explanation	Data Codes
Less than high school completion (no certificate, diploma or general educational development (GED) equivalency)	A
High school-level GED battery (does not have a high school diploma or certificate of equivalency)	B
High School completion (state certificate or equivalency)	C
High School completion (diploma)	D
12 to 29 semester hours or 18 to 44 quarter hours of post-secondary education completed (**Note 1**)	E
30 to 59 semester hours or 45 to 89 quarter hours of post-secondary education completed (includes 1-year post-secondary occupational certificates) (**Note 1**)	F
60 to 89 semester hours or 90 to 134 quarter hours of post-secondary education completed (includes 2-year post-secondary occupation certificates) (**Note 1**)	G
Awarded an associate's degree	H
Registered nurse (diploma school program graduate, 2–3-year program)	I
90 or more semester hours or 135 or more quarter hours completed (**Note 1**) but no bachelor's degree has been awarded and completed with at least one of the following conditions: - At least 20 semester hours or 30 quarter hours of upper division, 300 and/or 400 level credit - An official from the academic institution has provided in writing an official letter indicating the individual is within 30 or less semester hours or 45 or less quarter hours of completion of a bachelor's degree	J
Awarded a bachelor's degree	N
15 or more semester hours or 22 or more quarter hours of graduate work above the bachelor's level completed	O
Awarded a master's degree	P
30 or more semester hours or 45 or more quarter hours of graduate work above the master's level completed; doctoral candidate (all but dissertation)	Q
Awarded a doctorate degree (does not include honorary or professional degrees)	R
First professional degree (degree or certificate conferred by an accredited academic institution):	S
Chiropody or Podiatry (DSC or PodD)	
Dentistry (DDS or DMD)	
Medicine (MD)	
Optometry (OD)	
Osteopathy (DO)	
Pharmacy	
Veterinary Medicine (DVM)	
Law (LLB or JD)	

Note: Updates should occur no later than 15 days upon Service member entering a program.	
Data Items and Explanation	Data Codes
Theology (DB, Rabbi, or other first professional degree)	
Second professional degree	T
Third professional degree	U
Terminal degree as an education specialist	V
Not Sponsored by Military	Y
Currently in an AFIT bachelor's completion program (**Notes 2, 3 and 5**)	1
Currently in an AFIT master's degree completion program (**Note 3 and 5**)	2
Currently in an AFIT doctorate completion program (**Note 3 and 5**)	3
Currently in an AFIT first professional degree program (**Note 3 and 5**)	4
Currently in an AFIT second professional degree program (**Note 3 and 5**)	5
High School senior (Air National Guard and Air Force Reserve members only)	6
Obsolete. Only historical records exist in Military Personnel Data System (MilPDS); (e.g., engineer, industrial hygienist, certified public accountant, data processor, architect, teacher, etc.)	7
Technical/Occupational certificate program (**Note 4**)	8
NOTES: 1. Institutions granting credit values other than semester or quarter hours will be calculated at one semester hour for each 15 contact hours. 2. Applies to Service members enrolled in the Airman Education and Commissioning Program or officers enrolled in the Engineering Conversion Program. 3. Applies to officers assigned as a student to an AFIT unit, including AFIT's campus at Wright Patterson Air Force Base, AFIT civilian institutions, or other AFIT organization and enrolled in the applicable degree program. 4. Service member assigned as a non-student (e.g., commander or faculty member) to an AFIT organization and obtains a degree while assigned, in non-student status, should not use this code updated. 5. Technical/Occupational certificate programs must be documented on an official academic transcript.	

Table 6.3. Method/Resource Used to Obtain Education Level Codes.

Mandatory codes per DoDI 1322.10, *Policy on Graduate Education for Military Officers* reporting requirements.	
Data Items and Explanations	Data Codes
Military Service Academies (MIL SVC ACAD) (**Note 1**)	A
Air Force Educational Leave of Absence (AFELA)	B
AFIT Civilian Institution (AFIT CI) (**Note 2**)	C
Non-AFIT Sponsored Advanced Academic Degree Program (NON-AFIT AAD) (**Note 3**)	D
Airman Education and Commissioning Program (AECP)	E
AFROTC Educational Delay Program (ED DELAY PG)	F
USAFA Special Master's Degree Program (USAFA SMD PG)	G
Uniformed Services University of Health Sciences (USUHS)	H
College Senior Engineering Program (CSEP)	I
Community College of the Air Force (CCAF)	J
Educational Deferment Program (ED DEF PG)	K
Health Professions Scholarship Program (HPSP)	P
AFIT Engineering Program (AFIT EN)	R
AFIT Scholarship Program (AFIT SCH) (**Note 4**)	S
Military Tuition Assistance (MILTA)	T
Other Federally Funded Program (OTHER FED FUND PG) (**Note 5**)	X
Non-Sponsored Advance Academic Degree (NON-SPON AAD) (**Note 6**)	Y
Unknown (**Note 7**)	Z

NOTE:
1. Includes all military installations with academic institutions (e.g., Air Command and Staff College (ACSC), Naval Postgraduate School (NPS), National War College (NWC)) **Exception**: Do not use for programs specified in this table (e.g., AFIT Engineering Program, CCAF, etc.).
2. For civilian degrees obtained while on active duty (e.g., not on delayed entry) and status was managed through AFIT. Includes all special programs and degrees granting fellowships for degrees obtained at civilian academic institutions where Service member did not receive a full-tuition scholarship.
3. For advanced degrees obtained on active duty but the program was not funded by AFIT (e.g., funded by Major Command or Advance Studies Group (ASG)).
4. For degrees obtained while on active duty and assigned to a civilian academic institution on a full-tuition scholarship as a student and student status was managed through AFIT.
5. For advanced degrees obtained on active duty but used a non-DAF sponsored scholarship (e.g., Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA)).
6. For advanced degrees obtained using other funding outside of Military or Federal funds or no other code applies from this table.
7. Not permitted for graduate level degrees.

Chapter 7

MISCELLANEOUS EDUCATION RECORD UPDATES

7.1. Miscellaneous Education Record Updates. Education records that do not require updates to education level or ASC will follow the listings in **Table 7.1** for both officers and enlisted Service members.

Table 7.1. Miscellaneous Education Record Updates.

RULE	A If a Service member is	B then	C to	D within
1	an Air Force Reserve Officer Training Corps (AFROTC) distinguished graduate	The AFROTC school staff submits the Distinguished Graduate Certificate via MyFSS with the AF Form 24, *Application for Appointment as Reserve of the Air Force or USAF Without Component*	AFPC Line of Air Force (LAF) Officer Accessions (AFPC/DP1TSA) and member master personnel record in the Automated Records Management System	5 business days of commissioning.
2	an Officer Training School distinguished graduate	The Officer Training School staff submits the Distinguished Graduate certificate via MyFSS with the commissioning package	AFPC/DP1TSA and Officers master personnel record in the Automated Records Management System	5 business days of commissioning.
3	graduated or eliminated from AFIT	Assign AU Office of the Registrar (code C) and AFIT, Graduate Health Care Division (AFIT/CIM) (code R)	AU Office of the Registrar enlisted graduates must request transcripts be sent to their servicing E&TS **(T-1)**	90 calendar days of graduation or elimination. **(T-1)**

GWENDOLYN R. DeFILIPPI, SES, DAF
Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary of the
Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DAFPD 36-26, *Total Force Development and Management*, 15 April 2022

AFPD 10-3, *Operational Utilization of the Air Reserve Component Forces,* 29 November 2017

DODI 1322.10, *Policy on Graduate Education for Military Officers,* 29 April 2008

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 15 April 2022

Air University Catalog, 2024-2025

Adopted Forms

DD Form 214, *Certificate of Uniformed Service*

DD Form 1966, *Record of Military Processing – Armed Forces of the United States*

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

AF Form 24, *Application for Appointment as Reserve of the Air Force or USAF Without Component*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AAD—Advanced Academic Degree

ACSC—Air Command and Staff College

AECP—Airman Education and Commissioning Program

AFAEMS—Air Force Automated Education Management System

AFCOOL—Air Force Credentialing Opportunities On-Line

AFELA—Air Force Educational Leave of Absence

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFIT—Air Force Institute of Technology

AFIT CI—AFIT Civilian Institution

AFIT EN—AFIT Engineering Program

AFPC—Air Force Personnel Center

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

AFSC—Air Force Specialty Code

AFROTC—Air Force Reserve Officer Training Corps

AFVEC—Air Force Virtual Education Center

AI Portal—Academic Institution Portal

ARC—Air Reserve Component

ARMS—Automated Records Management System

AFR—Air Force Reserve

ANG—Air National Guard

ASC—Academic Specialty Code

ASG—Advanced Studies Group

AU—Air University

CCAF—Community College of the Air Force

CIP—Classification of Instructional Programs

CSEP—College Senior Engineering Program

DAF—Department of the Air Force (Air Force and Space Force)

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAFMAN—Department of the Air Force Manual

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DB—Theology

DDS—Dentistry

DMD—Dentistry

DO—Osteopathy

DoD—Department of Defense

DSC—Chiropody

DVM—Veterinary Medicine

E&TS—Education and Training Section

ED DELAY PG—AFROTC Educational Delay Program

ED DEF PG—Educational Deferment Program

FAFSA—Free Application for Federal Student Aid

GED—General Educational Development

JD—Law

LAF—Line of Air Force

LLB—Law

MD—Medicine

MilPDS—Military Personnel Data System

MILTA—Military Tuition Assistance

MIL SVC ACAD—Military Service Academies

NON-AFIT AAD—Non-AFIT Sponsored Advanced Academic Degree Program

NON-SPON AAD—Non-Sponsored Advance Academic Degree

NPS—Naval Postgraduate School

NWC—National War College

OD—Optometry

OPR—office of primary responsibility

OTHER FED FUND PG—Other Federally Funded Program

PodD—Podiatry

SMD PG—Special Master's Degree Program

TA—Tuition Assistance

USUHS—Uniformed Services University of Health Sciences

USAF—United States Air Force

USSF—United States Space Force

Office Symbols

AF/A1—Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services

AF/A1D—Directorate of Force Development

AF/A1DLE—Air Force Learning Division, Education Branch

AFCCVO—Air Force Centralized Credentials Verification Office

AF/RE—Chief of Air Force Reserve

AU Office of the Registrar—AFIT Academic Coding Branch

AFIT/CIM—AFIT Graduate Health Care Division

AFPC/DP1TSA—AFPC Officer Accessions, formerly AFPC/DP1TAM

AFPC/DP2N—AFPC Medical Career Management Division

AFPC/DP2NH—AFPC Chaplain Career Management Branch

AFPC/DP2NP—AFPC Physician Career Management Branch

AFPC/DP2SPP—AFPC Promotions Operations Security

AFRC—Air Force Reserve Command

AFRC/HC—Air Force Reserve Command Chaplain Corps

AFRC/JA—Air Force Reserve Command Staff Judge Advocate

AFRC/SG—Air Force Reserve Command Directorate of Health Services

AFRC/RS—Air Force Reserve Command Directorate of Recruiting Service

ARPC/DPAR—Air Reserve Personnel Center Accessions

DTA/DPRH—Digital Transformation Activity Human Capital Management Requirements

HQ USAF/JAX—Headquarters United States Air Force Judge Advocate General Corps' Professional Development Directorate

NGB/A1PO—National Guard Bureau Officer Programs and Policy

NGB/CF—Director of the Air National Guard

SAF/MR—Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Manpower and Reserve Affairs

SF/S1—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel

SF/S1D—Director, Force Development

USAFA—United States Air Force Academy

USAFA/A1—USAFA Manpower, Personnel, Services, and Officer Accessions Directorate

USAFA/DFVR—United States Air Force Academy, Dean of Faculty, Examination and Records

737th Training Squadron—Responsible for all enlisted basic military training for both the Air Force and Space Force

Terms

Airmen—Refer as a general term for any member of the USAF, AFR, ANG, regardless of rank.

ARMS—Is used as a records management system for personnel documents for all DAF members.

AU Office of the Registrar—Is the Academic Coding Branch for the Air Force Institute of Technology. Provides information and services to meet the needs of the AU community. Further tracks resident and nonresident education through AU schools and oversees the proper documentation of professional military education within the personnel system.

Certification—The recognition or credential given to an individual who has met predetermined qualifications set by an agency of government, industry, or a profession.

CIP codes—A system used in the United States to categorize academic programs at academic institutions of higher education. It's a hierarchical system, with codes ranging from broad two-digit groupings to more specific six-digit classifications. These codes are used for reporting and tracking educational data (e.g., program completions and enrollments).

Education—academic and experiential learning focused on general bodies of knowledge, principles within a given discipline, and habits of the mind. This type of learning is applicable to a broad spectrum of foundational and/or occupational competencies.

Guardian—Refer as a general term for any member of the USSF, regardless of rank.

MilPDS—Digital system to supports DoD members and their families in every aspect of a Service member's career, including accessions/enlistments (joining), assignments, career management, compensation, separation, and retirement.

MyFSS—Digital platform, the Department of the Air Force using as a Virtual Personnel Center for Airmen and Guardians.

Official Transcript—Official hard-copy and electric transcripts are accepted as official if provided following approved secure methods and processes. Hard-copy transcripts and other academic records are considered "official" when provided to a formal office requiring official transcripts (E&TS, AFIT, etc.) in a sealed, stamped, official envelope with the seal and any other security feature intact. Electronic transcripts are considered "official" when a formal office requiring official transcripts receives a secure site formally linked to the sending institution or testing service. Academic records received in any other condition, such as transcripts that arrived in an unsealed envelope, emailed, or uploaded by the student, or printed from the university portal, are not considered “official.”

Operational Utilization of the Air Reserve Component Forces—The combination of the Air National Guard and the Air Force Reserve; together they are called the Air Reserve Component. Air Force Policy Directive 10-3, *Air Reserve Component Forces*, establishes policy to fully integrate the Air National Guard, Air Force Reserve, and Regular Air Force into a single Total Force.

Service Member—Refer as a general term for any member of the Department of the Air Force (DAF) to include active duty Airmen and Guardians as well as Reserve and National Guard members.

Standard—An exact value, a physical entity, or an abstract concept, the appropriate authority, custom, or common consent sets up and defines to serve as a reference, model, or rule in measuring quantities or qualities, developing practices or procedures, or evaluating results. A fixed quantity or quality.